9 With the box completed, it is now almost ready for parting off. I intend to texture the surface, but if you prefer a smooth polished surface then sand and polish before parting off

Texturing

10 It is important that the lines of the texture are vertical down the box and that they all start and end at the same level. To help with this, draw pencil lines on the box as a guide. The texturing is fairly straightforward with the corner of a square-ended cutter in a rotary tool. The texturing raises small splinters and wispy bits of 'fuzz' on the wood, which can be removed with a fine wire brush or abrasive 'bristle discs'

11 Texturing always looks better with well-defined start and finish lines, and to achieve this the box is returned to the lathe in order to cut in slightly at the top and bottom of the texturing with a small parting tool. To prevent the top coming off, hold it in place with some insulating tape

12 The box is then parted off and reversed onto long nosed jaws used in expansion mode just inside the recess for the lid. This allows you to clean up the bottom of the box, taking light cuts with a small bowl gouge

13 After buffing, the box is finished

The 'pebble' box

14 For this box design, you'll need a small piece of yew approximately 75mm diameter and 50mm thick, containing both heartwood and sapwood, with the grain running from side to side rather like a small bowl blank. Mount it between centres, then true up the blank and form a shallow 5mm dovetail spigot on each side. Then, using a narrow parting tool, divide the blank into two slightly unequal parts approximately 16 and 19mm thick

15 The thicker part is the box base. Holding it by the spigot, hollow it out with a gouge, refine with a scraper, then sand and seal and cut a recess to receive the lid. Take care to allow enough wall thickness for the beads, which mark the joint between lid and box

16 Use a 3mm bead forming tool to make a bead right on the very edge of the box, blending the curve of the bead into the flat area where the top and bottom will meet

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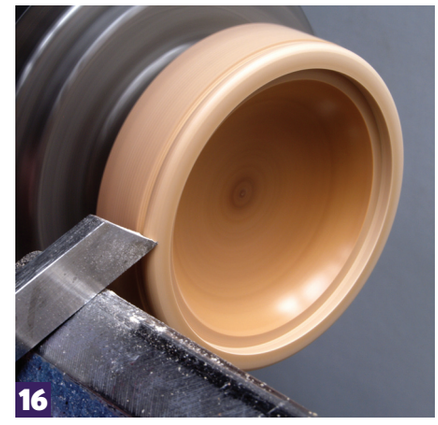
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